

Chapter 4 – Metasploit Framework

Part 7 – Post-Exploitation Concepts (Professional Methodology)

Overview

Post-exploitation is the phase after successful vulnerability verification during an authorized assessment. The focus is on understanding impact, collecting evidence, assessing risk, documenting findings, and cleaning up.

Primary Objectives

Understand the affected system, validate business impact, identify additional security weaknesses, collect evidence, and recommend remediation.

Information Gathering

Document the operating system, installed software, patch level, user context, hostname, network configuration, running services, and security controls.

Risk & Evidence

Assess business impact, determine risk severity, and collect reproducible evidence such as system information, configuration details, screenshots (where permitted), and timestamps.

Key Concepts

Persistence and pivoting should only be evaluated when explicitly authorized and within the agreed scope. The emphasis is on defensive assessment rather than maintaining access.

Cleanup & Reporting

Remove temporary assessment artifacts, close sessions, restore the environment if needed, and prepare a report containing an executive summary, technical findings, evidence, risk ratings, and remediation recommendations.

Quick Revision

Professional post-exploitation is about validation, evidence, documentation, cleanup, and reporting—not simply obtaining access.